MintFI/RE

Case Study

MintFI/RE

Bridging Traditional and Modern Finances to Achieve Financial Freedom

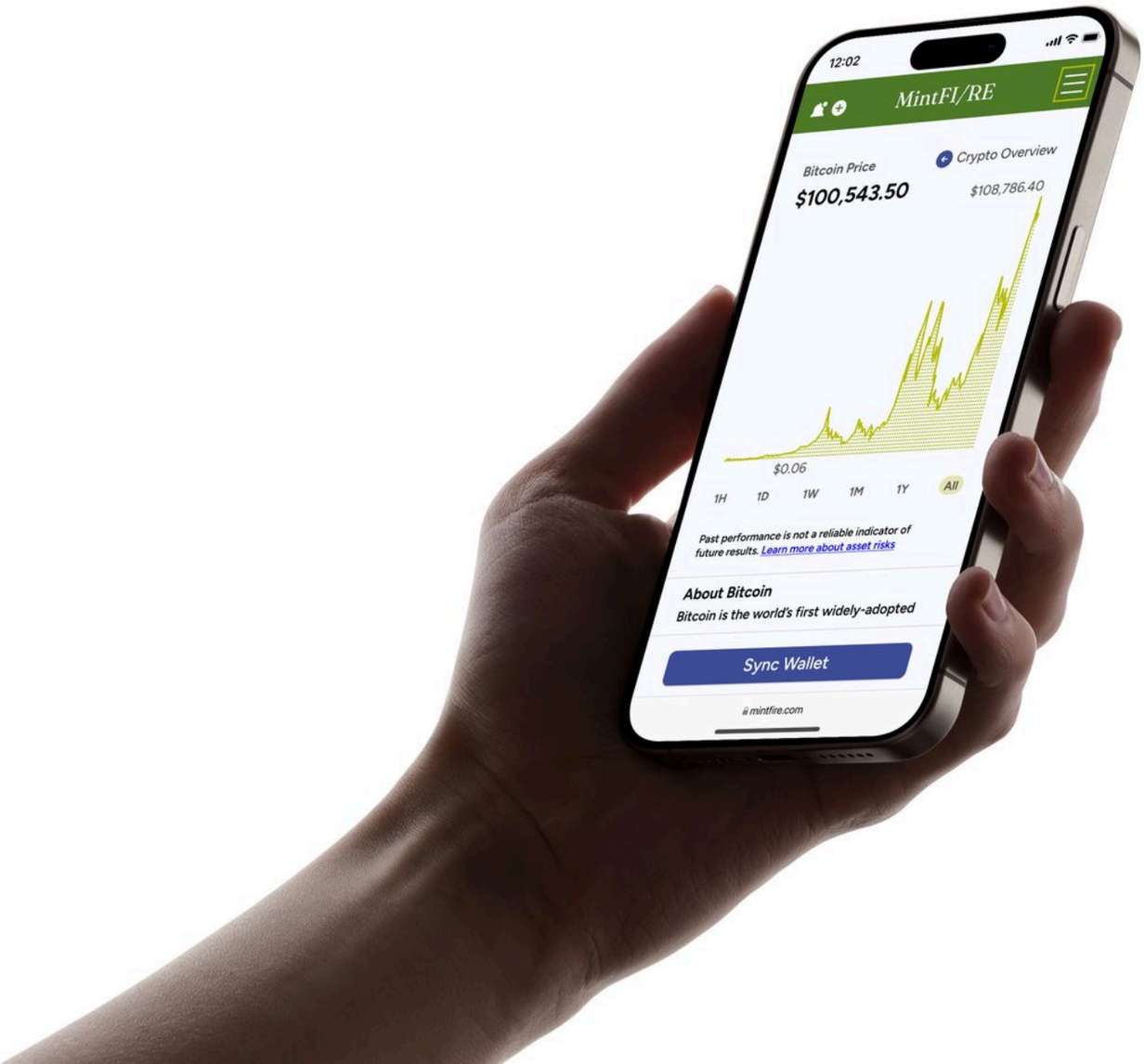
A community-driven web app to boost portfolio performance and financial literacy

Overview

This project focused on designing the MintFI/RE app to provide a comprehensive platform for managing finances. As part of my CareerFoundry UI course, I took on the roles of UX, UI, and research designer, aiming to create a user-friendly interface that encourages financial literacy and community engagement.

MintFI/RE is a comprehensive financial management web application designed to help users achieve Financial Independence and potentially Retire Early (FIRE). The platform integrates traditional and modern investment accounts while providing budgeting tools, financial education, and community-building features.

The outcome of this project is that I successfully delivered a functional prototype demonstrating all core features within course timeline, with additional self-directed UX research components.



My Role

UX, UI & Research Designer

Timeline

3 Months

Client

CareerFoundry
(Student Project)

Context

UI Case Study - MintFI/RE is a mobile-first responsive web app.

Tools

Figma
Balsamiq
Adobe Photoshop
Google Forms

Challenge

Market Opportunity

The financial wellness market is projected to reach $1.5 billion by 2026, yet current solutions force users to juggle multiple platforms to manage their complete financial picture.

While traditional budgeting apps focus on expense tracking and investment platforms handle portfolio management, no single solution addresses the growing FIRE (Financial Independence, Retire Early) movement's unique needs for holistic financial tracking, goal-oriented planning, and community support.

This fragmentation creates a significant opportunity: users seeking financial independence need a unified platform that connects their diverse financial accounts, provides clear progress tracking toward their FIRE goals, and offers educational resources alongside a supportive community of like-minded individuals.

User Problems Identified

Through preliminary research and market analysis, several critical pain points emerged:

Financial Fragmentation: Users manage investments across traditional platforms (401k, IRAs, stocks) and modern alternatives (cryptocurrency, robo-advisors), making it nearly impossible to see their complete financial picture without manual spreadsheet tracking.

Goal Tracking Complexity: Calculating progress toward financial independence requires complex math across multiple account types, with users often unsure if they're on track or how different savings rates would impact their timeline.

Educational Resource Scatter: Financial education content is spread across blogs, podcasts, books, and courses, with no personalized learning path based on individual financial situations or FIRE goals.

Community Isolation: The FIRE journey can feel lonely, with limited opportunities to connect with others at similar stages or in similar geographic areas for accountability and motivation.

Problem

Users face fragmented financial management due to the lack of integration between traditional and modern finance tools.

Today's financial landscape is increasingly complex, with investments spread across traditional accounts (401k, IRAs, stocks) and modern platforms (cryptocurrency, NFTs, alternative investments). Users struggle to:

1. Get a unified view of their complete financial picture
2. Track progress toward financial independence goals
3. Access trustworthy financial education
4. Connect with like-minded individuals on similar journeys

Solution

A **mobile-first web app** that seamlessly bridges traditional and digital finance. The platform enables users to **consolidate and visualize** all financial accounts in one intuitive dashboard – from 401(k)s and IRAs to crypto wallets and NFTs.

Through **real-time data integration**, users can track their complete net worth, monitor investment performance, and automate savings goals. The platform delivers **curated educational content** and **connects users** with local financial meetups, all optimized for on-the-go financial management.

Design Objectives

Based on these identified challenges, MintFI/RE was designed to achieve three core objectives:

1. **Unified Financial Visibility**: Create a single dashboard that aggregates all financial accounts and investments, providing users with a real-time, comprehensive view of their net worth and asset allocation.

2. **FIRE-Focused Goal Tracking**: Develop intuitive tools for setting, tracking, and optimizing progress toward financial independence, including scenario planning and timeline projections based on different savings and investment strategies.

3. **Integrated Learning & Community**: Combine personalized financial education with location-based community features, enabling users to improve their financial literacy while connecting with others on similar journeys.

These objectives guided every design decision, ensuring MintFI/RE would address real user needs while differentiating itself in the competitive fintech landscape.

Design Process

Empathizing with Personas

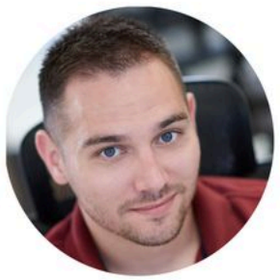
To better understand the user needs, motivations and pain points, I developed three key personas to guide the design process who are on their own individual journeys towards FI/RE.

1. **Early Stage Saver** - Young professional focused on debt repayment and starting to invest
2. **Mid-Career Accumulator** - Building significant investments across multiple platforms
3. **Near-FI Optimizer** - Approaching financial independence, focused on optimizing withdrawals

02 Empathize

To better understand the user's needs, motivations and pain points, I created two main personas who are on their own individual journeys towards FI/RE.

Dalí - Tech Junkie & Early Investor



34 years old, not married, has a partner

Software Engineer at Fortunate 500 company

Wants to have two kids, then to retire by 42 and relocate his family to Portugal.

Lives in Oakland, CA

Needs & Goals

- Dalí aims to achieve FIRE (Financial Independence, Retire Early), balancing personal finances, investments, and cryptocurrency holdings.
- He seeks a tool to help him create and track a budget, manage his investments and monitor his progress towards FIRE.
- Chris wants to make informed financial decisions and stay organized in his approach to achieving financial independence.

Motivations

- Dalí has invested from an early age but has trouble staying organized and focused on the long-term goals.
- Since he has plenty of cryptocurrency investments which are volatile and often affect his moods, he wants to diversify into traditional investments.

Frustrations

- He has no idea how much his net worth is and doesn't know how to project his future worth.

Everyday Activities

- Wakes up early, swims laps.
- Makes coffee and works from home until noon.
- Has lunch then heads to work.
- Connects with team from 3:00 - 4:00, goes home and finishes tasks while listening to podcast.
- Cooks healthy dinner with partner.

Devices & Internet Usage

Desktop	★★★★★
Mobile	★★★★★
Social	★
Technical Know-How	★★★★★

Notable Quotes

"After seeing my father work until 80 years old, I'm determined to achieve financial independence, retire early, pursue hobbies and enjoy life with my family."

"I need a tool that can help me create a budget, manage my investments and cryptocurrency assets, and monitor my progress toward FIRE all in one place. This could make or break my financial journey."

Marielle - Social Butterfly with a FOMO



27, single

Social Media Associate at Ad Agency

Bachelors degree in Marketing from Miami University

Has a lot of student loans and excessive credit card debt, recently sober

Lives in Miami, FL

Needs & Goals

- Marielle is ambitious and has big financial goals. However, she's dealing with significant debt, which she wants to eliminate as part of her journey to FIRE.
- She is highly motivated to learn about personal finance, budgeting, investment strategies and real estate.
- Seeks a tool that will help her create a budget to aggressively pay off her debt while saving for her future.
- Marielle wishes to connect with a community of individuals with similar financial aspirations to learn from their experiences and stay motivated.

Motivations

- To eliminate her credit card debt and student loans.
- Aspires to pursue FIRE after watching a lot of Youtube success stories.
- Wants to connect with like-minded individuals striving for FIRE, share experiences, and seek motivation and advice.
- She is newly sober and wants to surround herself with others who are serious about their finances.

Frustrations

She struggles to budget and save.
She is intimidated by finance, and seeks a resource that simplifies the process and provide guidance tailored to her investment goals.
Her friends are a bad influence on her spending, so she's decided to distance herself and immerse herself into a community of like-minded people with similar goals.

Everyday Activities

- Wakes up early, makes coffee and walks dog.
- Works from home, attends Zoom meetings.
- Meets a friend for lunch.
- Finishes work day.
- Walks dog, goes to gym.
- Makes dinner or orders Uber Eats.

Devices & Internet Usage

Desktop	★★★
Mobile	★★★★★
Social	★★★★★
Technical Know-How	★★

Notable Quotes

"I know that I can achieve my financial goals, but I need guidance, motivation, and a structured approach. I want to pay off my debt, retire early, and learn about smart investments. Finding a supportive community along the way would be incredible."

Task Flows

Defining User Interactions

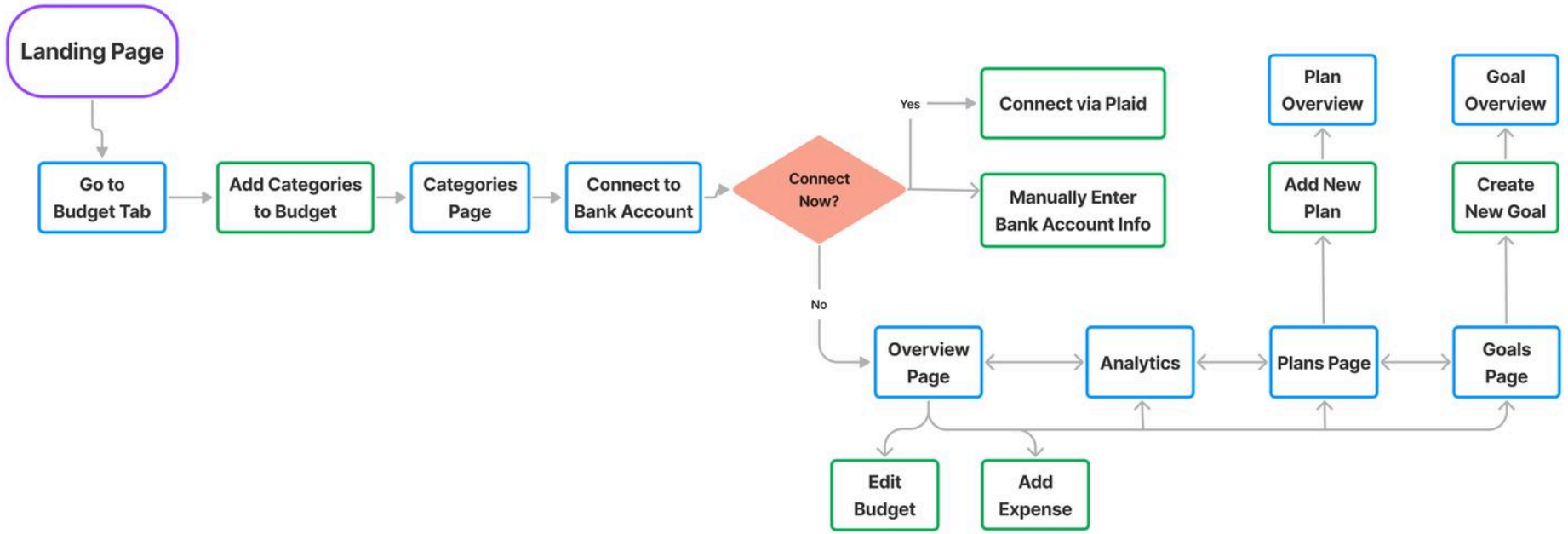
With user personas established, I mapped out the core task flows that would define the MintFI/RE experience. These flows were designed to address the primary pain points identified in my research: financial fragmentation, complex goal tracking, and the need for simplified budget management.

I focused on three essential user journeys that would deliver immediate value while supporting long-term financial independence goals:

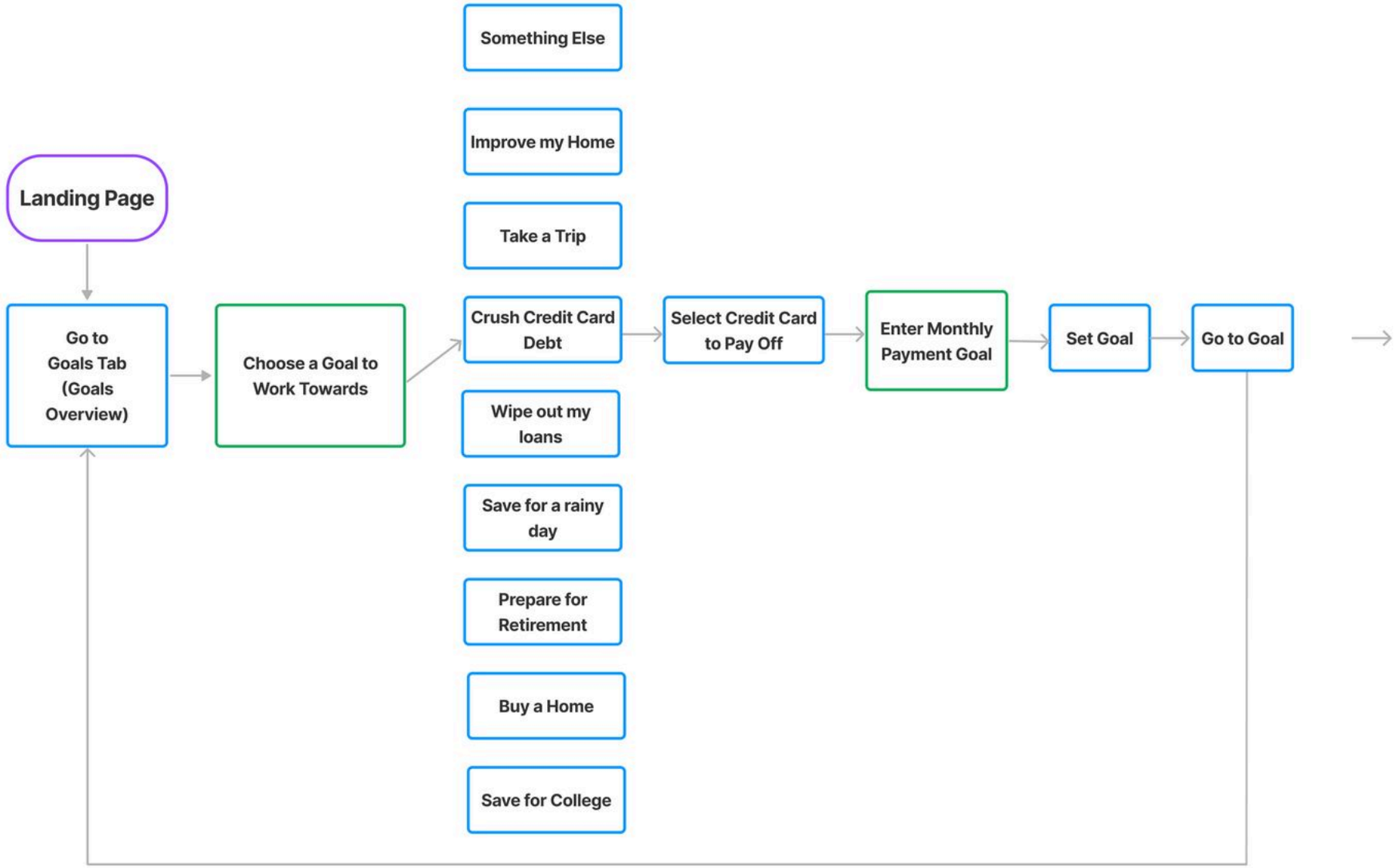
03 Ideate

I then created task flows in order to visualize the steps needed, and which screens to design, in order for the personas to complete their goals.

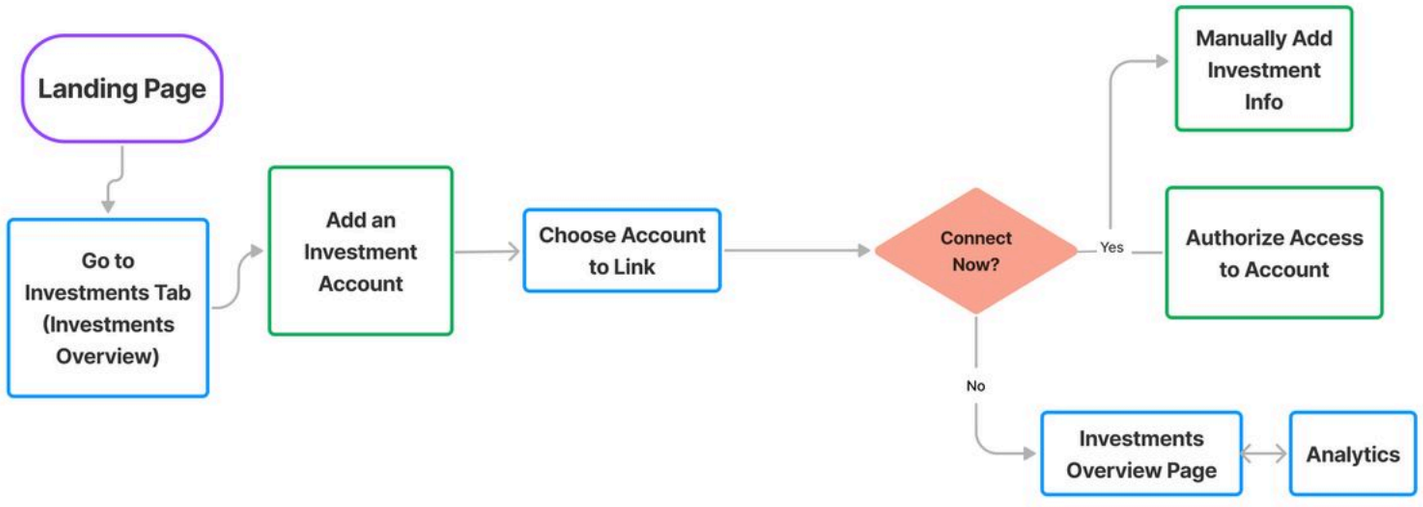
Task Flow: Creating a Budget



Task Flow: Creating a Goal



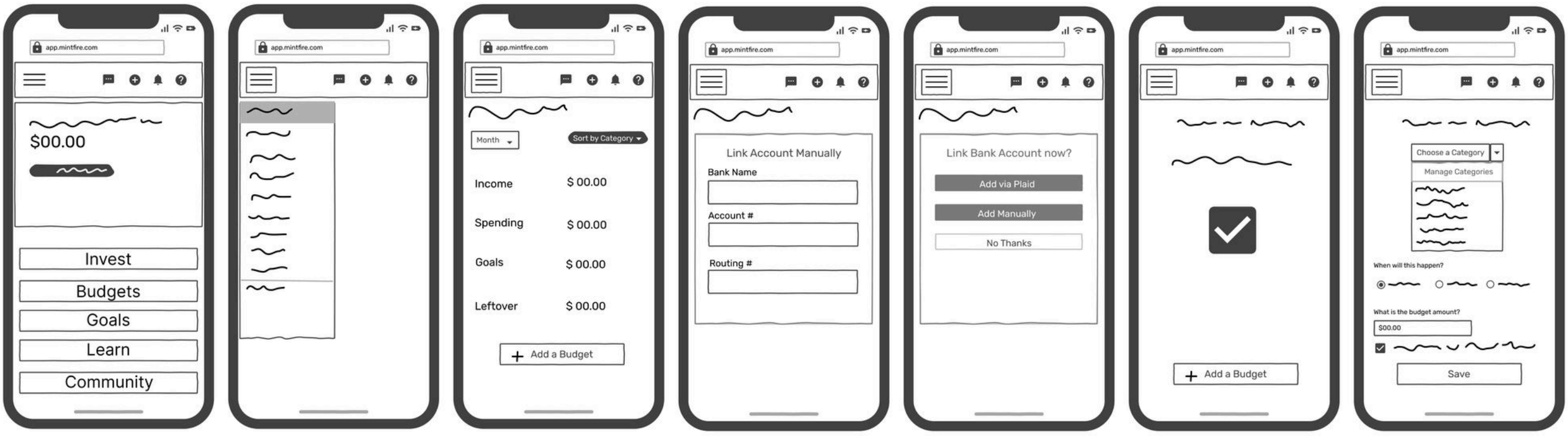
Task Flow: Managing & Tracking Investments



04 Design & Prototype

Based on the personas and task flows, I designed the main functionalities if the app for mobile using Balsamiq.

Lo-fi: Creating a Budget



Lo-fi: Managing & Tracking Investments



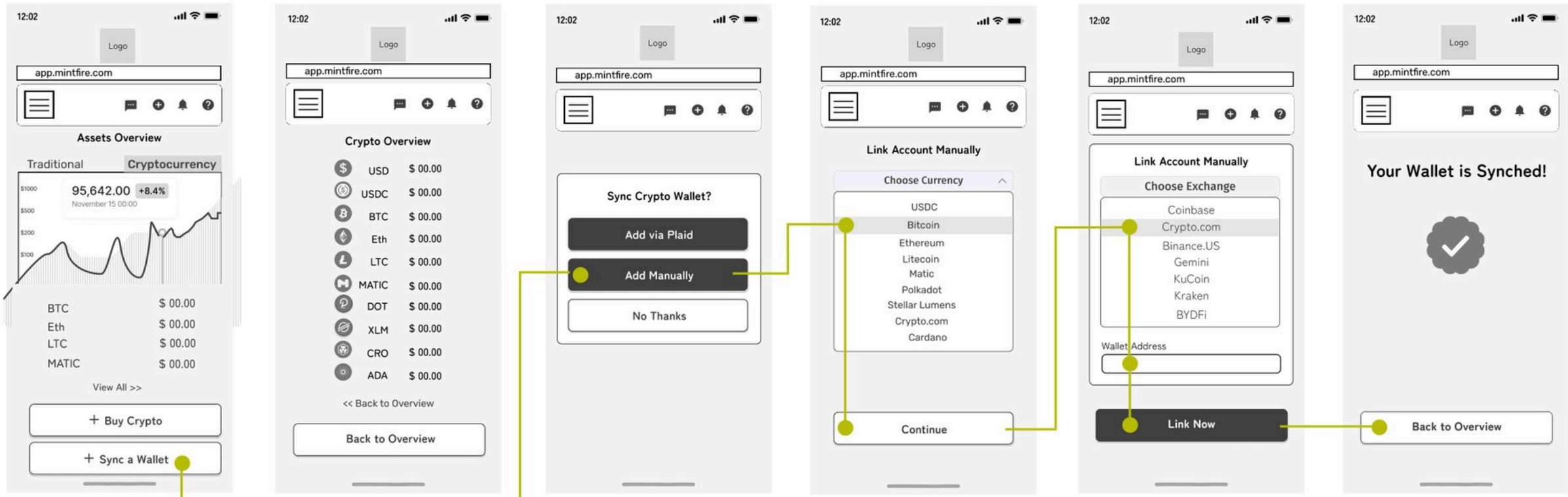
Wireframes

Concepts were born using Balsamiq. I created low-fidelity screens that showcase how users will walk through tasks. I then focused on the UI elements, illustrations and text to better convey the form and function of the app, transforming it into mid-fidelity wireframes.



I then focused on the UI elements, illustrations and text to better convey the form and function of the app, transforming it into mid-fidelity wireframes,

Mid-fi: Syncing a Crypto Wallet



Mood Board 1 Bright, Coastal, Trustworthy, Clean, Contrast, Conservative

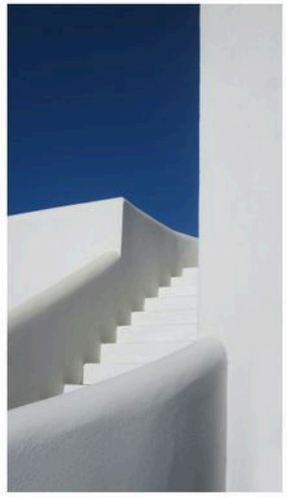


Embracing financial liberty under the Mediterranean sun, where knowledge sets sail for wealth's horizon.

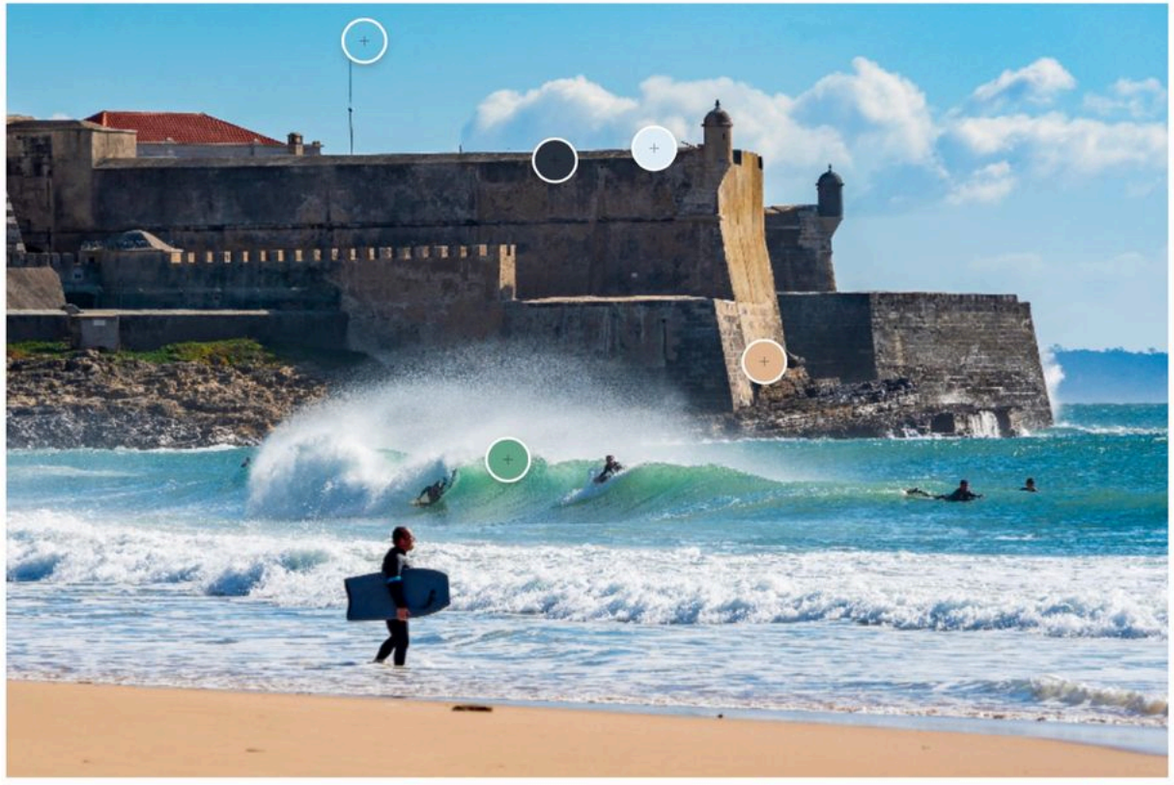




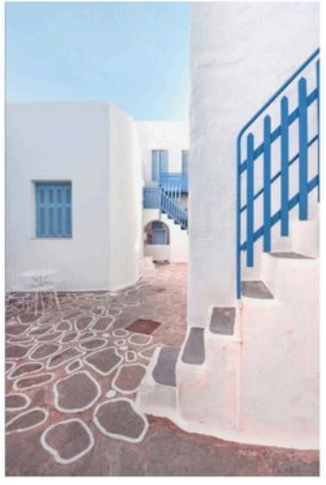
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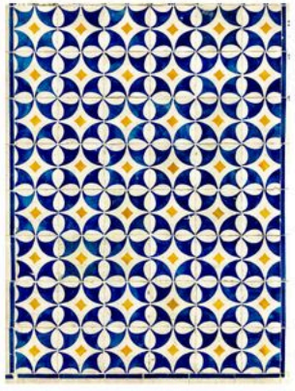






WILSON
INVESTMENT







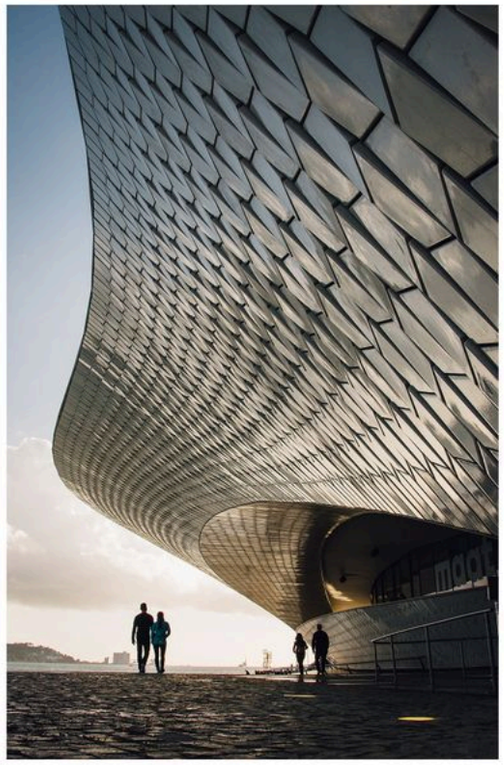
Mood Board 2: Winner

Calming, Organic, Textural, Laid back

FINANCE

URBANISTIC
DEVELOPMENT
INSTITUTE

Discovering financial vitality inspired by the organic rhythm of nature...







...where education nurtures wealth's natural growth.



#A4ABBF #DFE5F2 #628567 #B9BF04 #0D0D0D

Aeonik Medium



UI Design

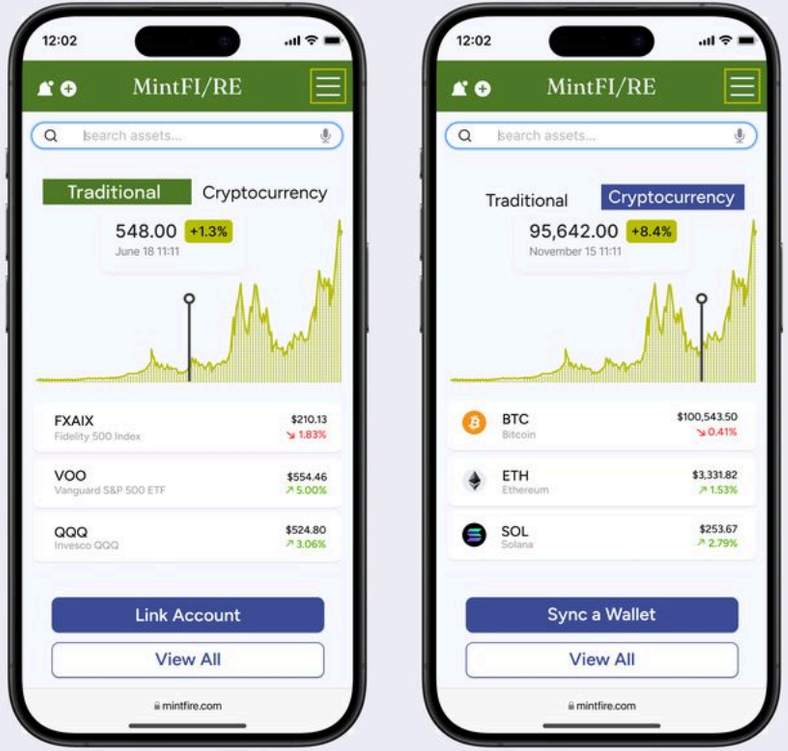
I designed the final screens in Figma. My goal was to create a visual identity that's aligned with the brand's values and message.

- **Interface**: modern, polished.
- **Fonts:** conservative and traditional word-mark, the very paradox that the app showcases through its features. Modern copy.
- **Colors**: modern, lots of green symbolizing money and success. Green also channels the opportunity to live a flexible lifestyle and get grounded in nature. It signifies a calm freedom in all senses - physical, mental and financial.
- **Guidelines**: Human Interface (iOS)
- **Devices**: iPhone, iPad, MacBook, iMac, with a focus on mobile.

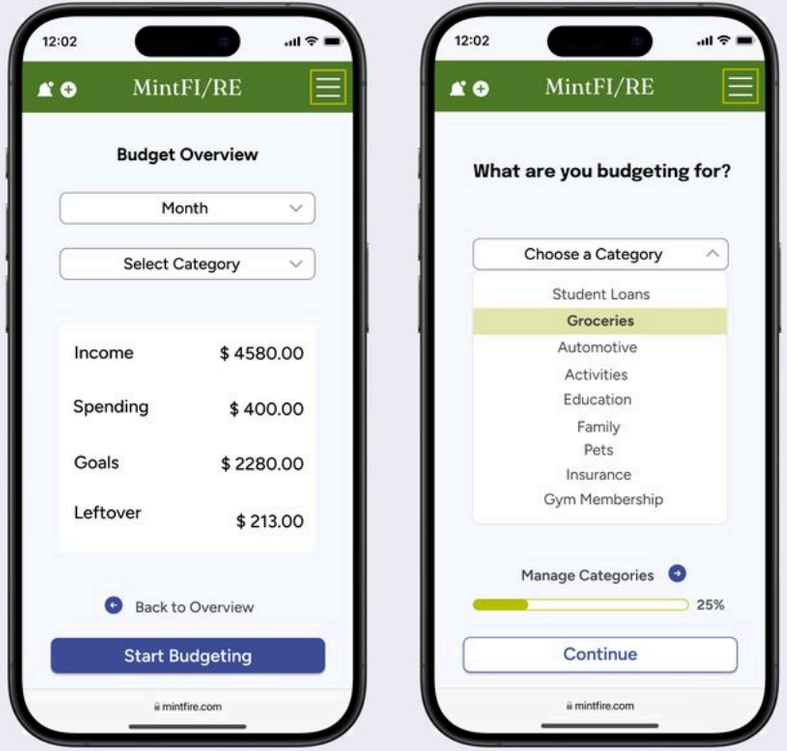
Information Architecture

The app is centered around four core functionalities

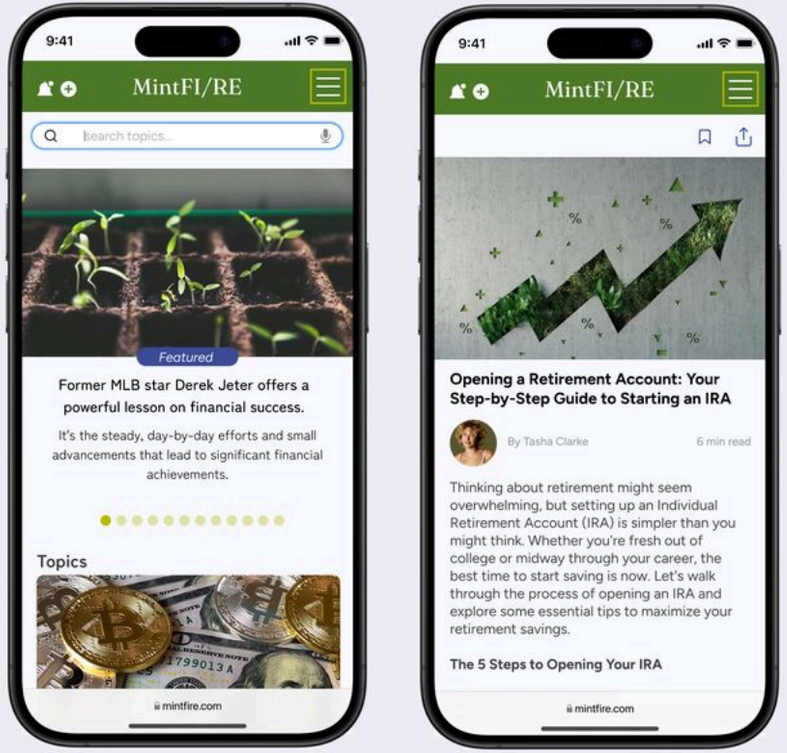
1. **Investment Analytics**: Holistic financial overview



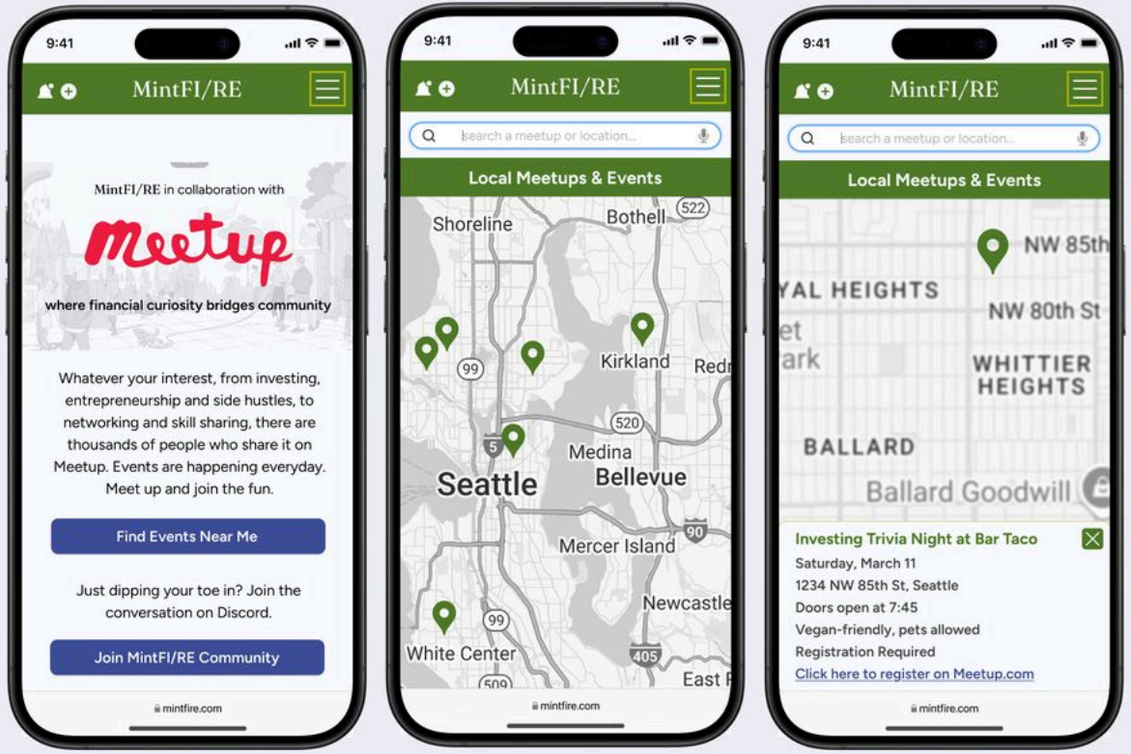
2. **Tracking & Planning**: Budgeting and Goal Setting



3. **Learn**: Financial education content



4. **Community**: Events and discussion forums



12:02

MintFI/RE

Sign In

Register

Continue as a Guest

AA mintfire.com

12:02

MintFI/RE

Your Credit Score

814

Your Credit Score is Excellent!

Last Check on February 1

Back to Overview

See Score Details

See What's Changed

mintfire.com

9:41

MintFI/RE

roth ira

What is a Roth IRA?

How to open a Roth IRA

Traditional IRA vs. Roth IRA

Allowable Investments in a Roth IRA

Are Roth IRAs Insured?

Who is eligible for a Roth IRA?

Disadvantages of a Roth IRA

Withdrawals from an IRA

Former MLB star Derek Jeter offers a powerful lesson on financial success.

It's the steady, day-by-day efforts and small advancements that lead to significant financial achievements.

Topics



mintfire.com

NET WORTH +

$640,819.00

Assets	$940,819.00
Liabilities	$300,000.00

Cash

Chase	Joint Checking - Ending in...	$1000.00 · 2 hrs ago
Aspiration	Savings - Ending in 3856	$12000.00 · Just Now
TD Bank	Checking - Ending in 2845	$2000.00 · 53 min ago

Investments

Ameritrade	Securities - Ending in 9378	$168,400.00 · 2 hrs ago
Vanguard Total...	Mutual Fund - Ending in 1747	$285,000.00 · 16 min ago
Personal Strategy	IRA - Dalí Rodriguez	$95,619.00 · 4 min ago
Personal Strategy	ETF - Dalí Rodriguez	$189,300.00 · 4 min ago
Invesco QQQ Trust	ETF - Dalí Rodriguez	$142,500.00 · Just Now
Scholarshare Ca...	Dalí Rodriguez - Ending...	$45,000.00 · 8 hrs ago

Credit Cards

American Express	Black - Ending 3810	$1800.00 · 9 hrs ago
Chase Sapphire	Reserve - Ending 9387	$2200.00 · 3 min ago

Net Worth

-$12,367 (-2.00%)

Money Flow | 6 Month



Budgeting



Mortgage	$1800.000
Restaurants	$259.00
Automotive	$400.00
Groceries	$610.00
Travel	$1100.000
All Others	$941.00

1 of 2

Cashflow

$00.00

Income this month $15,000.00

Last Month

Expenses this month -$5110.00

Last Month

Up $12,364.00 this year

Increase your return by 4%

Our team of experts has developed a unique algorithm that analyzes market trends and makes strategic investment decisions on your behalf. This means you can sit back and relax while our product works its magic, increasing your returns and minimizing risks.

See Recommendations

1 of 5

Upcoming Events

Investing Trivia Night at Bar Taco
Saturday, December 11

Financing a Home with Cryptocurrency
Sunday, December 13

Budgeting for a Family
Friday, December 18

Navigating Finances Throughout Marriage
Sunday, December 20

View All

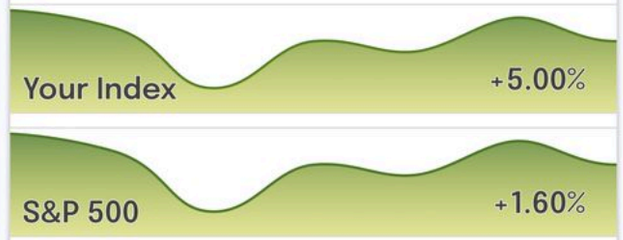
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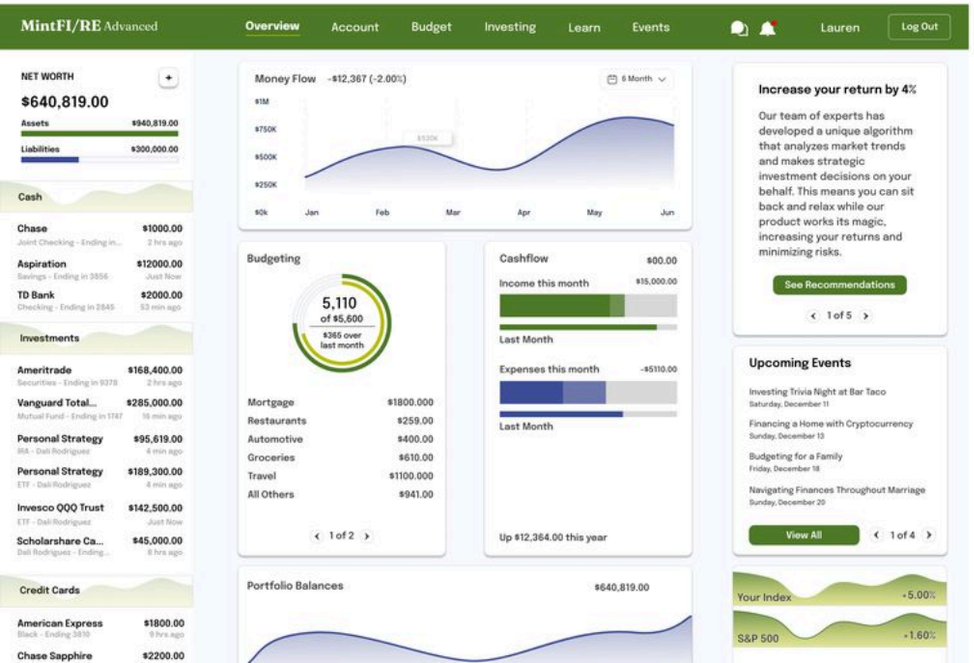
Portfolio Balances

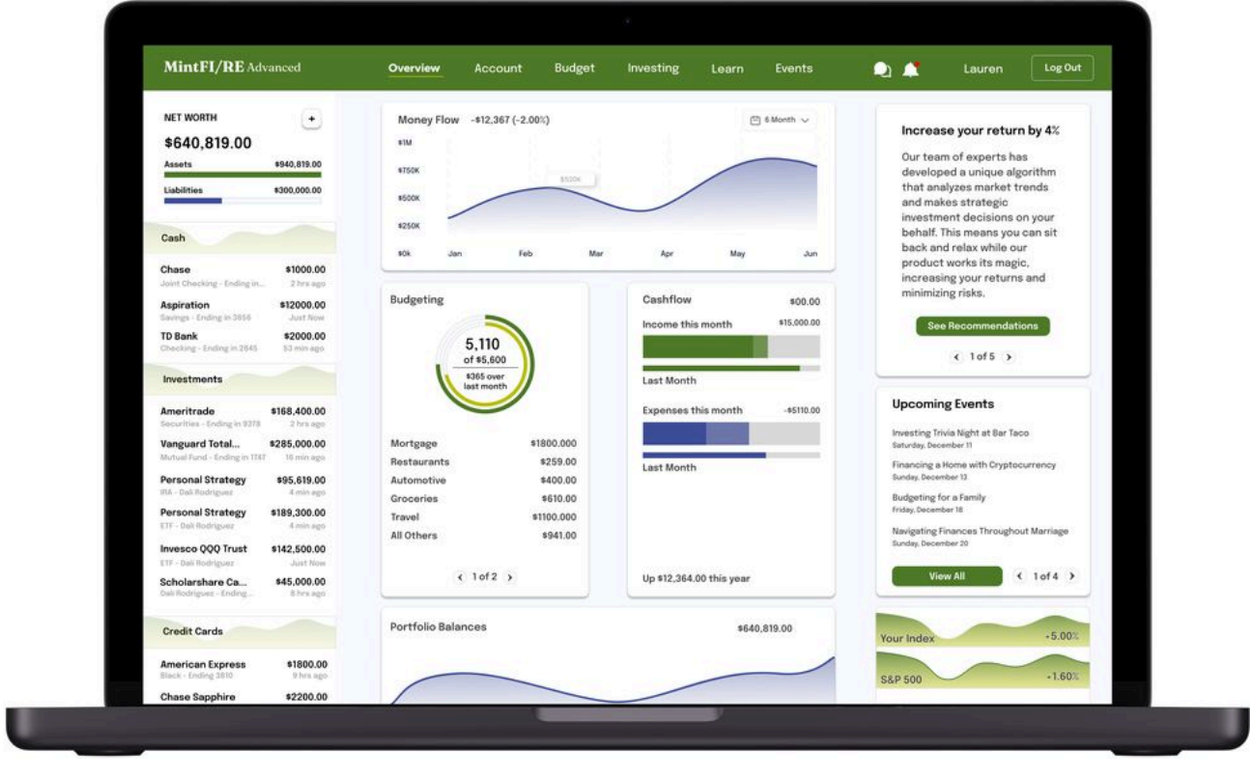
$640,819.00



Market Movers




MintFI/RE Advanced
Overview
Account
Budget
Investing
Learn
Events
Lauren
Log Out
NET WORTH
$640,819.00
Assets $940,819.00
Liabilities $300,000.00
Cash
Chase $1000.00
Joint Checking - Ending in... 2 hrs ago
Aspiration $12000.00
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Black - Ending 3810 9 hrs ago
Chase Sapphire $2200.00
Money Flow -$12,367 (-2.00%)
6 Month
$1M
$750K
$500K
$250K
$0k
$520K
Jan
Feb
Mar
Apr
May
Jun
Budgeting
5,110
of $5,600
$365 over last month
Mortgage $1800.000
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1 of 4
Your Index +5.00%
S&P 500 +1.60%

MintFI/RE Advanced

Overview | Account | Budget | Investing | Learn | Events | Lauren | Log Out

search articles...

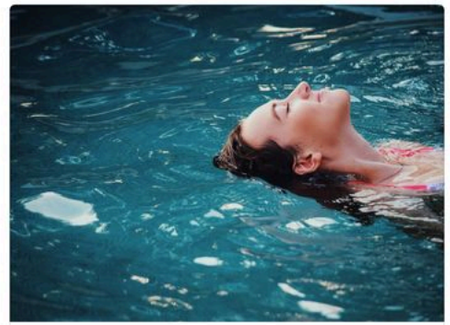
Featured Articles

Curated articles for you based on your search history



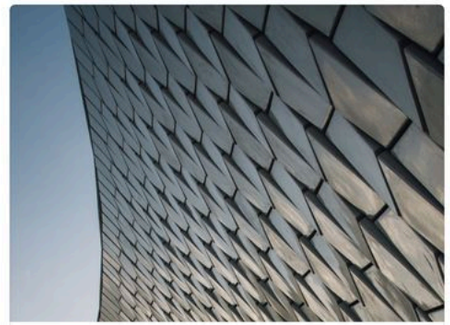
Former MLB star Derek Jeter offers a powerful lesson on financial success

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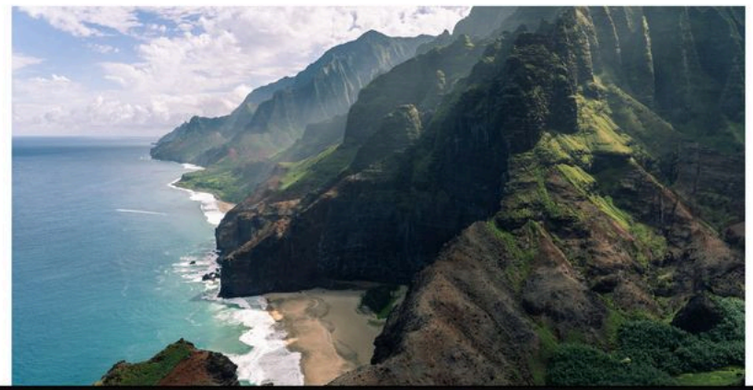
The Magic of Compound Interest: Turning Small Savings into Big Gains

Learn the financial magic behind compound interest and how consistent small savings can grow into significant wealth over time. Dive into the key principles of compounding for a richer financial future.



Navigating Market Volatility: Lessons from Historic Economic Shifts

Gain insights from past economic shifts to navigate and thrive in volatile markets. Learn strategies for making informed decisions in uncertain financial landscapes.



Topics

Explore various investment topics



Stock Market Investing

Beginner-Friendly

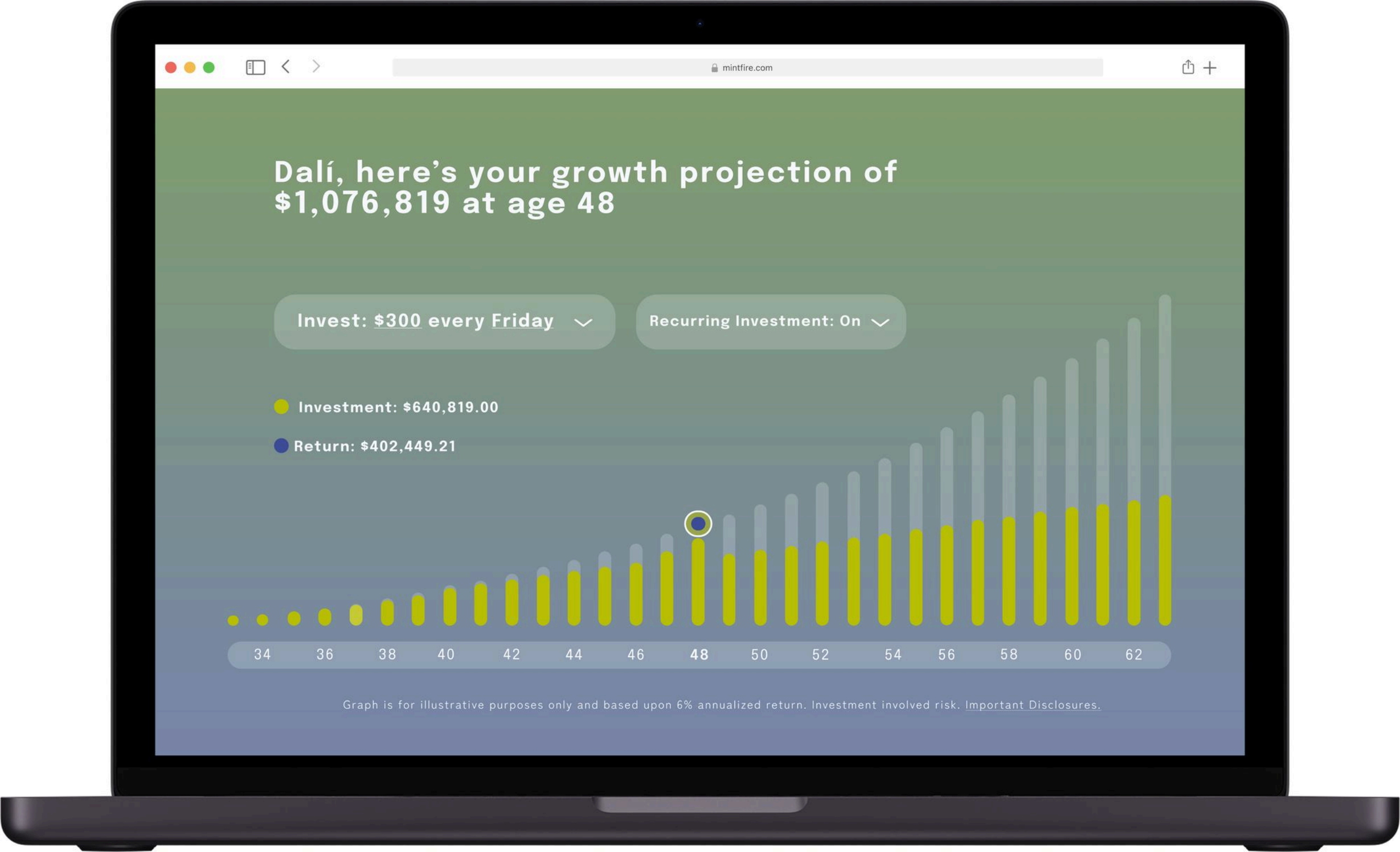
Learn the basics of investing in the stock market.

Basics | Stocks

Erica Sumner



What is a Cold Storage Wallet?


mintfire.com
Dalí, here's your growth projection of $1,076,819 at age 48
Invest: $300 every Friday
Recurring Investment: On
Investment: $640,819.00
Return: $402,449.21
34
36
38
40
42
44
46
48
50
52
54
56
58
60
62
Graph is for illustrative purposes only and based upon 6% annualized return. Investment involved risk. Important Disclosures.